PART 3

# Demo Escalation Policy

Document ID: POL-PLC-003 | Revision: 1.0 | Status: SYNTHETIC DEMO

## 1. Purpose

Provides a clear, time-boxed route for escalating PLC problems on the Filler Cell so the right people respond quickly and decisions are recorded. This is a demonstration policy with fictional contacts.

## 2. Severity levels

| Severity | Description | Examples | Response target | Resolution target |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| S1 - Critical | Line down or safety-relevant risk | CPU in STOP unexpectedly, ERROR LED solid red, power loss, loss of all I/O | 5 min | 4 h or workaround |
| S2 - High | Major function degraded | Loss of PROFINET device, repeated cycle-time overruns, memory card error | 15 min | 1 shift |
| S3 - Medium | Minor degradation, line running | Intermittent HMI alarm, single I/O channel fault with workaround | 2 h | 3 working days |
| S4 - Low | Request or cosmetic | Label updates, documentation requests | 1 working day | Planned |

## 3. Escalation ladder (fictional contacts)

| Level | Role / name | Phone (fake) | Escalate when |
|---|---|---|---|
| L1 | Shift maintenance technician - R. Khan | +91-00000-10001 | First responder for all alarms |
| L2 | Controls engineer on call - A. Rao | +91-00000-10002 | Not resolved in 30 min (S1) or 2 h (S2), or any program/config change is needed |
| L3 | Maintenance manager - M. Verma | +91-00000-10003 | S1 beyond 1 h, any safety concern, or production loss over agreed threshold |
| L4 | Siemens support / regional partner (via support portal) | Portal ticket | Suspected hardware defect or firmware issue after L2 review |
| L5 | Plant manager - S. Iyer | +91-00000-10005 | S1 beyond 4 h, customer or regulatory impact |

## 4. Rules of engagement

- Safety first: if people may be at risk, stop the line using the hardwired E-stop and escalate to L3 immediately, regardless of severity table.
- Capture evidence before power cycling: diagnostic buffer export, LED states (photo), time, and current CPU mode. A restart may clear information.
- Do not factory-reset, change passwords, or overwrite the program without L2 approval.
- The incident owner is the highest level currently engaged. Handover must be spoken or written, never assumed.
- Provide updates to the shift supervisor every 30 min for S1 and every 2 h for S2.

## 5. Escalation flow

| Step | Action |
|---|---|
| 1 | Detect alarm or finding. Classify severity using the table above. |
| 2 | L1 checks LEDs, HMI alarms, power and cabling; records initial evidence. |

| Step | Action |
|---|---|
| 3 | If unresolved within target time, escalate to L2 with evidence pack. |
| 4 | L2 reviews diagnostics, compares project online/offline and decides on restart, rollback or part replacement. |
| 5 | If hardware or firmware defect is suspected, open Siemens support ticket (L4) and inform L3. |
| 6 | Close: confirm normal operation, update Part 4, hold a short review for S1/S2. |

## 6. Post-incident review

For every S1 and S2, a review is held within 5 working days covering timeline, root cause, corrective actions and owners. Results are filed with the maintenance history.